



Tips & Tricks



A shell script to check if the network host is up

Here's a shell script that uses *ping* to check if a network host is up on the Internet:

```
HOSTS="yahoo.com"
for HOST in $HOSTS
do
    ping -c5 $HOST > /dev/null
    #suppress output, if host is up
    if [ $? -ne 0 ]
    then
        echo -n "$HOST unreachable on $(date +%d/%m/%Y-%H-%M-%S)" >> file.log
        #if there's a problem, print error message, and the date
    else
        logger "ping: $HOST OK"
        #log created at syslog
    fi
done
exit 0
```

—Anil Bakhtani, anil_bakhtani@yahoo.com



Generate sequences

You can use the *seq* command to generate sequences. For example:

```
seq 1 5
```

The output for the above command will be:

```
1
2
3
4
5
```

The above can be used in many places including scripts. For example:

```
$ for i in `seq 1 5`; do echo "i is $i"; done
i is 1
i is 2
i is 3
i is 4
i is 5
```

—Shiv Premani, shivpremani@gmail.com



Make your Linux box speak

Ubuntu and many other distros have an inbuilt speech synthesiser called *espeak*. Use the following command in the terminal:

```
espeak "I can speak"
```

Did you hear your Linux box report, "I can speak"?

—Saaz Rai, saaz.raai@gmail.com



Change X's resolution on the fly

In order to change the resolution of X we can make use of the command *xrandr*. Simply type this command on a terminal and it will display all resolutions supported by the X window. Then in order to set the resolution of the X window to one of the supported resolutions, say 1024x768, simply execute the following:

```
xrandr -s 1024x768
```

It will immediately change the resolution of the X window, on the fly.

—Pankaj Kumar, pankaj@glug4muz.org